

RustDesk Service & Boot Accessibility Audit

System Diagnostic, Service Verification & Pre-Login Analysis

Target System: Windows OS Host | Investigation Date: 31/08/2026 | Last System Boot: 31/08/2026 15:55:51

EXECUTIVE AUDIT SUMMARY:

- **Is RustDesk running as a system service? YES.** The RustDesk service is actively running under the LocalSystem (NT AUTHORITY\SYSTEM) security account with startup type set to **Automatic** (AUTO_START).
- **Was it remotely accessible at the Windows screen after reboot? YES.** During the last reboot at 15:55:51, the service daemon launched at 15:56:04 (Session 0) and immediately instantiated the Session 1 server helper at 15:56:05 to bridge the Secure Desktop, enabling remote login before any user authenticated.

1. Windows Service Configuration Audit

Live inspection of the Windows Service Control Manager (SCM) via sc.exe qc RustDesk and Get-Service yielded the following parameters:

Parameter	Configured Value	Operational Impact
Service Name	RustDesk	System service registered in SCM
Display Name	RustDesk Service	Official RustDesk Windows Daemon
Status	Running	Currently active and listening
Startup Type	Automatic (AUTO_START / 2)	Initializes at OS boot before user login
Binary Path	"C:\Program Files\RustDesk\RustDesk.exe" --service	Service execution mode
Logon Account	LocalSystem (NT AUTHORITY\SYSTEM)	Full system token & desktop privileges
Service Type	WIN32_OWN_PROCESS	Runs in isolated process instance

2. Boot Timeline & Process Chronology

Correlating the operating system boot event with active process telemetry confirms that RustDesk initiated before interactive user sessions:

Process ID	Session	Timestamp	Functional Role & Description
N/A	OS Kernel	15:55:51	System Boot Up (Win32_OperatingSystem LastBootUpTime)
PID 4872	Session 0	15:56:04 (+13s)	Service Daemon: Starts automatically under LocalSystem
PID 5744	Session 1	15:56:05 (+14s)	Logon Server Helper: Connects to Winlogon pre-login screen
PID 11080	Session 1	16:04:09	User Tray Interface: Launched upon interactive user logon
PID 9948	Session 1	16:04:23	Program Files Tray Helper: GUI taskbar companion

3. Mechanics of Pre-Login Remote Accessibility

Remote access at the Windows login screen requires specific OS capabilities that standard user applications cannot provide:

- **Automatic Startup Before Logon:** Because the startup type is AUTO_START, the Windows Service Control Manager activates the service 13 seconds after boot without waiting for a user password or physical logon.
- **LocalSystem Privileges & Secure Desktop:** Standard desktop apps running as normal users cannot access the Secure Desktop (Winlogon / Ctrl+Alt+Del lock screen / UAC prompts). The RustDesk service runs as NT AUTHORITY\SYSTEM, providing the security credentials required to capture the login screen.
- **Session 0 to Session 1 Injection:** Windows isolates background services in Session 0. RustDesk bridges this by spawning a worker process into Session 1 (PID 5744 at 15:56:05). This enables incoming connections from remote clients to view the login prompt, input credentials, and log into Windows remotely.

Final Summary: RustDesk is fully configured as a persistent system service. It initialized 13 seconds after the last reboot and was completely accessible remotely at the Windows login screen.